

MAKING LIVES BETTER THROUGH EDUCATION

Understanding the Workspace of Tableau

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Objectives:

At the end of the session, you will be able to:

1. Perform the necessary setup to use the Tableau desktop
2. Explore the workspace of the Tableau desktop

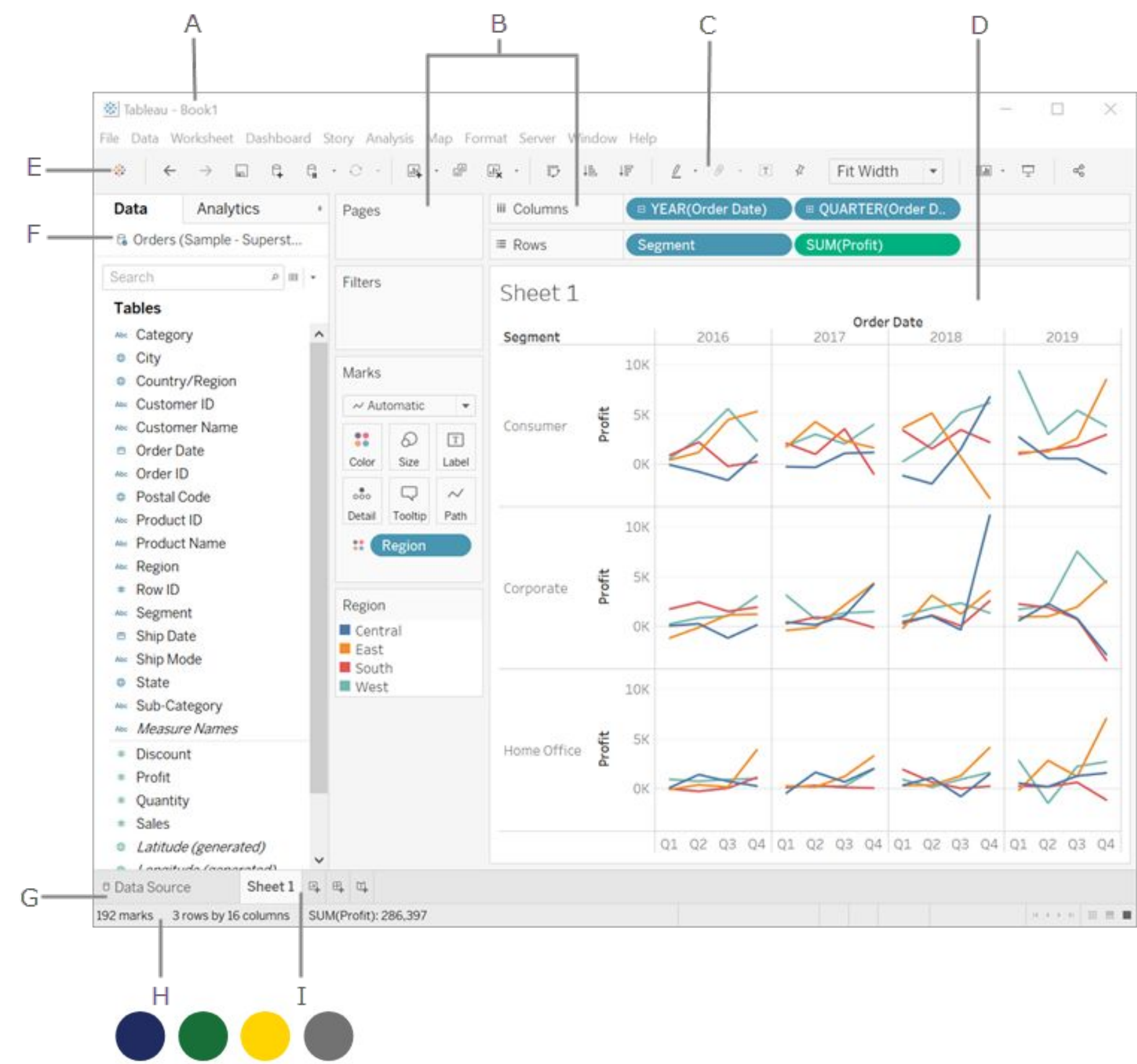


Tableau Workspace

- The Tableau Workspace is the main working area in Tableau where you build your visualizations, dashboards, and stories. It consists of menus, a toolbar, a data pane, cards and shelves, and one or more sheets. Sheets can be worksheets, dashboards, or stories.
- Think of it as your **canvas** where all the tools and data come together.

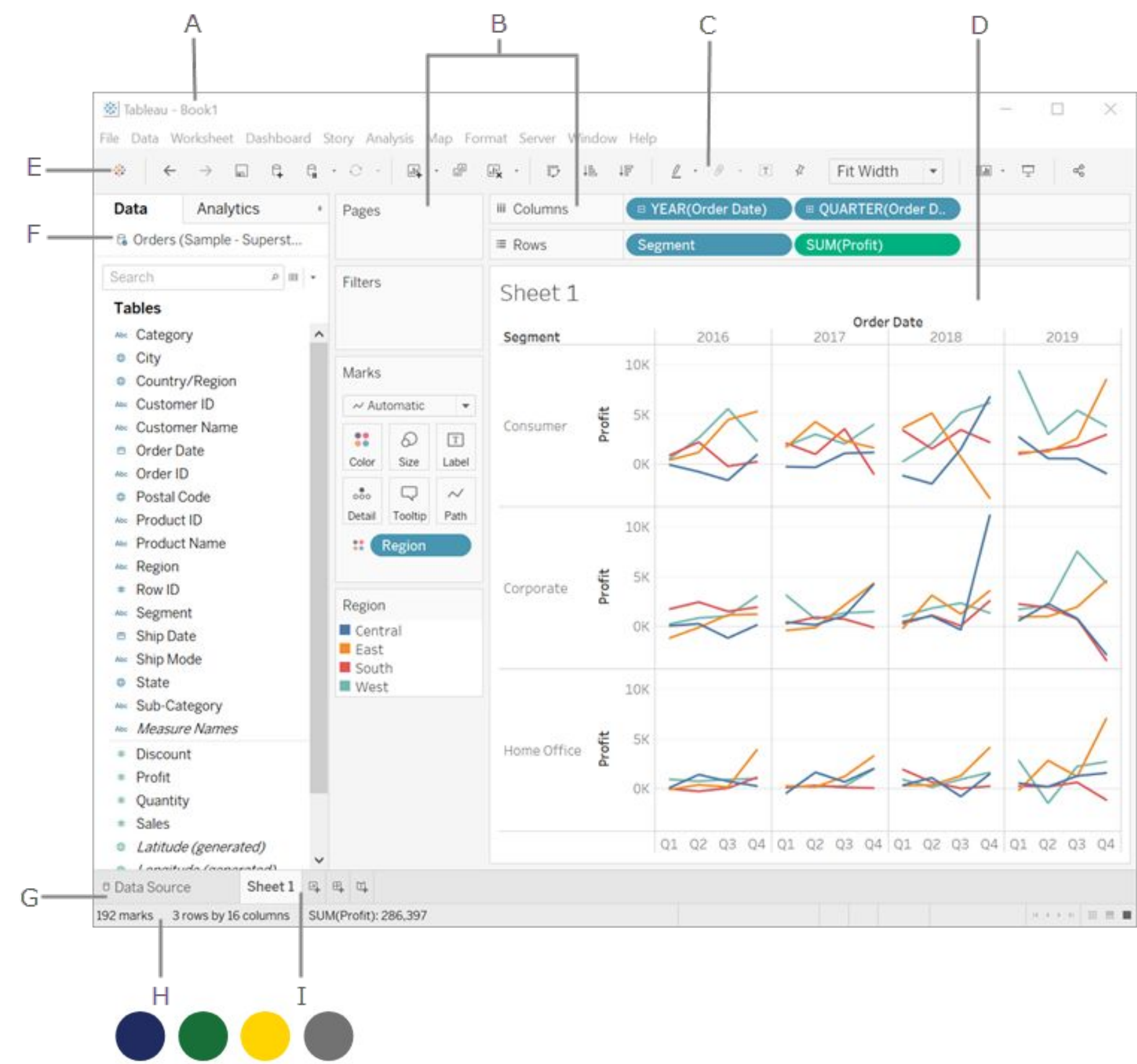


Tableau Workspace



- A. Workbook Name- A workbook contains sheets. A sheet can be a worksheet, a dashboard, or a story.
- B. Cards and shelves- Drag fields to the cards and shelves in the workspace to add data to your view.
- C. Toolbar- Use the toolbar to access commands and analysis and navigation tools.

Tableau Workspace



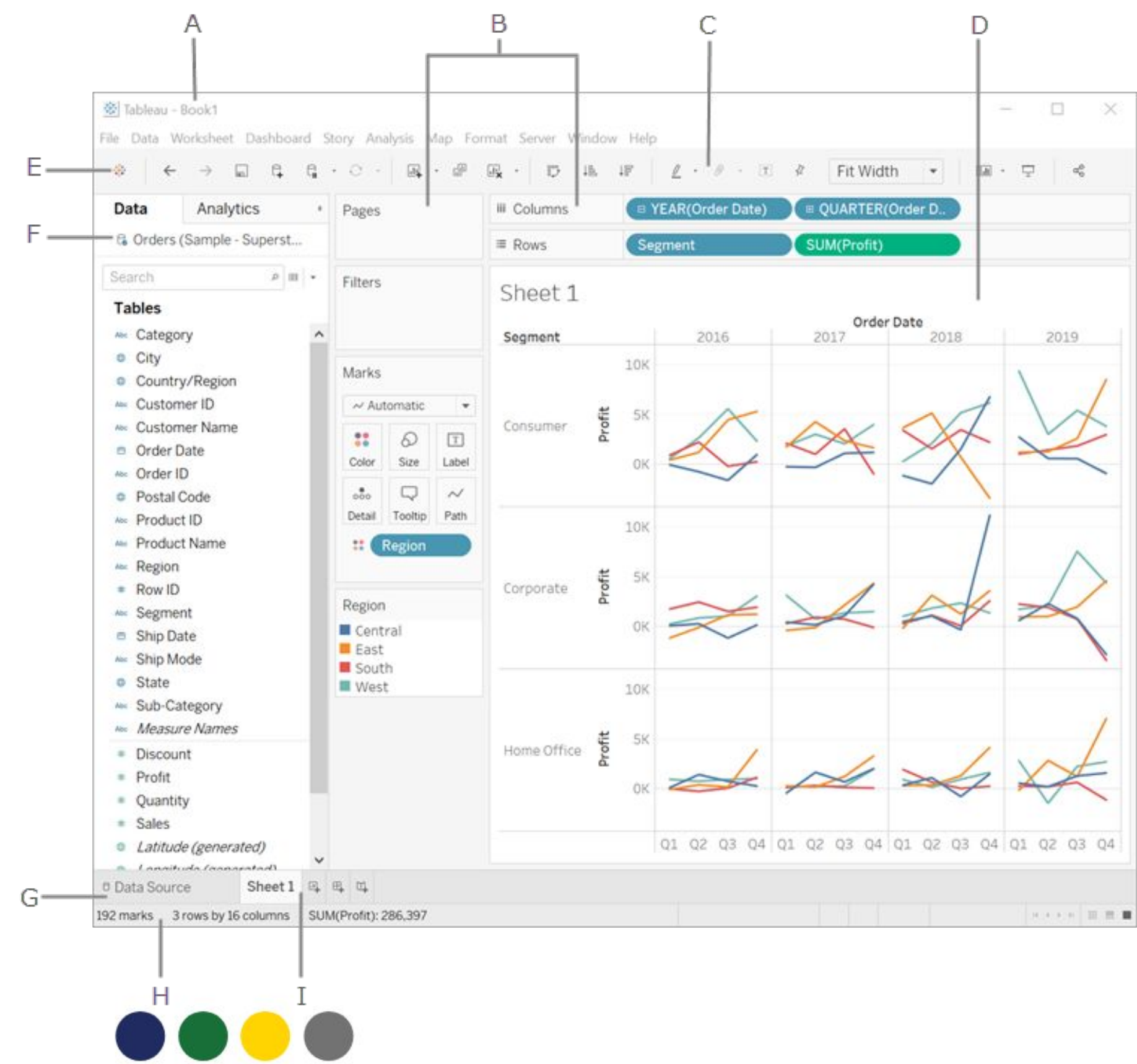
D. View- This is the canvas in the workspace where you create a visualization (also referred to as a "viz").

E. Show Start Page- Click this icon to go to the Start page, where you can connect to data.

F. Side Bar- In a worksheet, the sidebar area contains the Data pane and the Analytics pane.

G. Data Source- Click this tab to go to the Data Source page and view your data.

Tableau Workspace



H. Status bar- Displays information about the current view.

I. Sheet tabs- Tabs represent each sheet in your workbook.

This can include worksheets, dashboards,
and stories.

Tableau Toolbar Icons

The Tableau toolbar contains a variety of icons that allow users to perform different functions on Tableau Desktop. These icons are organized into groups based on their functionality.

Toolbar Button	Description
	Tableau icon: Navigate to the start page. Note: Tableau Desktop only.
	Undo: Reverses the most recent action in the workbook. You can undo an unlimited number of times, back to the last time you opened the workbook, even after you have saved.
	Redo: Repeats the last action you reversed with the Undo button. You can redo an unlimited number of times.
	Save: In Tableau Desktop, saves the changes made to the workbook. In Tableau Server or Tableau Online, click File > Save or File > Save As to save your changes.
	New Data Source: In Tableau Desktop, opens the Connect pane where you can create a new connection or open a saved connection. In Tableau Server or Tableau Online, opens the Connect to a Data Source page, where you can connect to a published data source.



Tableau Toolbar Icons

	Pause Auto Updates: Controls whether Tableau updates the view when changes are made. Use the drop-down menu to automatically update the entire sheet or just use filters.
	Run Update: Runs a manual query of the data to update the view with changes when automatic updates are turned off. Use the drop-down menu to update the entire worksheet or just use filters. Note: Tableau Desktop only.
	New Worksheet: Creates a new blank worksheet, use the drop-down menu to create a new worksheet, dashboard, or story.
	Duplicate: Creates a new worksheet containing the same view as the current sheet.
	Clear: Clears the current worksheet. Use the drop-down menu to clear specific parts of the view such as filters, formatting, sizing, and axis ranges.



Tableau Toolbar Icons

	Swap: Moves the fields on the Rows shelf to the Columns shelf and vice versa. The Hide Empty Rows and Hide Empty Columns settings are always swapped with this button.
	Sort Ascending: Applies a sort in ascending order of a selected field based on the measures in the view.
	Sort Descending: Applies a sort in descending order of a selected field based on the measures in the view.
	Totals: You can compute grand totals and subtotals for the data in a view. Select from the following options: • Show Column Grand Totals: Adds a row showing totals for all columns in the view. • Show Row Grand Totals: Adds a column showing totals for all rows in the view.

Tableau Toolbar Icons

	• Row Totals to Left: Moves rows showing totals to the left of a crosstab or view. • Column Totals to Top: Moves columns showing totals to the top of a crosstab or view. • Add All Subtotals: Inserts subtotal rows and columns in the view, if you have multiple dimensions in a column or row. • Remove All Subtotals: Removes subtotal rows or columns. Note: Tableau Server and Tableau Online only. In Tableau Desktop, click Analysis > Totals.
	Highlight: Turn on highlighting for the selected sheet. Use the options on the drop-down menu to define how values are highlighted.
	Group Members: Creates a group by combining selected values. When multiple dimensions are selected, use the drop-down menu to specify whether to group on a specific dimension or across all dimensions. Note: Tableau Desktop only. In Tableau Server and Tableau Online, create groups using the Group Members button on the tooltip.



Tableau Toolbar Icons

	Show Mark Labels: Switches between showing and hiding mark labels for the current sheet.
	Fix Axes: switches between a locked axis that only shows a specific range and a dynamic axis that adjusts the range based on the minimum and maximum values in the view. Note: Tableau Desktop only.
	Format Workbook: Open the Format Workbook pane to change how fonts and titles look in every view in a workbook by specifying format settings at the workbook level instead of at the worksheet level. Note: Tableau Server and Tableau Online only. In Tableau Desktop, click Format > Workbook.

Tableau Toolbar Icons

	Fit: Specifies how the view should be sized within the window. Select Standard, Fit Width, Fit Height, or Entire View. Note: This menu is not available in geographic map views. The Cell Size commands have different effects depending on the type of visualization. To access the Cell Size menu in Tableau Desktop click Format > Cell Size.
	Show/Hide Cards: Shows and hides specific cards in a worksheet. Select each card that you want to hide or show on the drop-down menu. In Tableau Server and Tableau Online, you can show and hide cards for the Title, Caption, Filter and Highlighter only.
	Presentation Mode: Switches between showing and hiding everything except the view (i.e., shelves, toolbar, Data pane). Note: Tableau Desktop only.



Tableau Toolbar Icons

	Download: Use the options under Download to capture parts of your view for use in other applications. • Image: Displays the view, dashboard, or story as an image in a new browser tab. • Data: Displays the data from the view in a new browser window with two tabs: Summary, showing aggregated data for the fields shown in the view, and Underlying, showing underlying data for the selected marks in the visualization. If the new window does not open, you may need to disable your browser's popup blocker. • Crosstab: Saves the underlying data for the selected marks in the visualization to a CSV (comma-separated values) file which can then be opened in Microsoft Excel. • PDF: Opens the current view as a PDF in a new browser window. From there you can save it to a file. If the new window does not open, you may need to disable your browser's pop-up blocker. Note: Tableau Server and Tableau Online only.
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Tableau Toolbar Icons

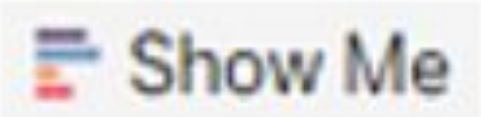
	Share Workbook With Others: Publish your workbook to Tableau Server or Tableau Online. Note: Tableau Desktop only.
	Show Me: Helps you choose a view type by highlighting view types that work best with the field types in your data. An orange outline shows around the recommended chart type that is the best match for your data.

Tableau Activity: Analyzing Sales Performance

Use the Sample Superstore dataset (already available in Tableau) and do the following:

Step 1: Connect Data

1. Open Tableau.
2. Connect to the **Sample Superstore** dataset.

Step 2: Create Worksheets

1. Bar Chart – Sales by Category

- Drag **Category** to Columns
- Drag **Sales** to Rows
- Sort by descending sales

2. Line Chart – Sales Over Time

- Drag **Order Date** to Columns (choose Month/Year)
- Drag **Sales** to Rows
- Add **Profit** as color or dual-axis

3. Pie Chart – Profit by Region

- Drag **Region** to Rows
- Drag **Profit** to Size/Color
- Convert to Pie

Step 3: Add Filters

- Add a **filter** for **Year**
- Add a **filter** for **Region**

Step 4: Create a Dashboard

1. Go to **Dashboard → New Dashboard**
2. Drag the three worksheets into the dashboard
3. Add a title: *"Sales & Profit Performance Dashboard"*
4. Enable filters so users can interact (e.g., filter all charts by Region or Year).

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